

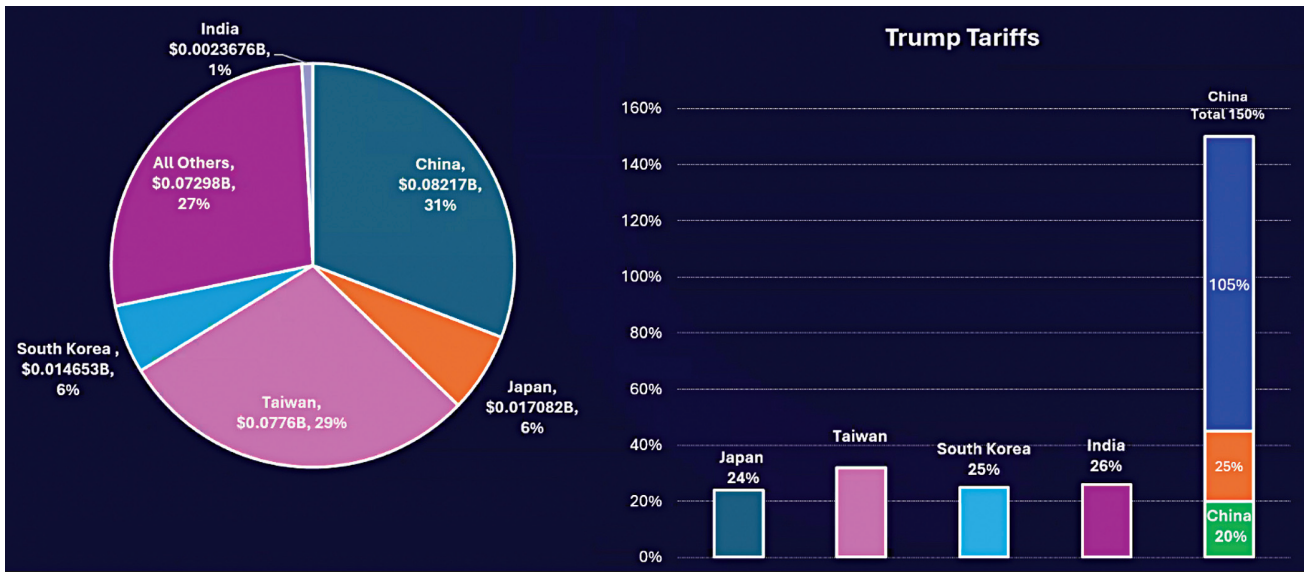


Fig. 4: Major exporters of printed circuit boards (853400) to the USA

typically halved to create a reciprocal discounted rate designed to reduce market disruption. Yet, this often introduces further complexity for businesses attempting to forecast costs.

For countries like India, where trade balances fluctuate, tariff rates shift accordingly, impacting the cost structure of everything from raw materials to finished products.

The complex puzzle of 'country of origin'

At the heart of these policy shifts lies a simple question: Where is a product truly from? For electronics assembled with parts from multiple countries, the answer is complicated. The US uses the doctrine of 'substantial transformation' to determine origin. If a product's

components are merely assembled—not significantly altered—it is not considered manufactured in that country.

In global electronics trade, the label on a product is more than branding—it determines tariffs and legal compliance. For US imports, whether a device is classified as 'Made in India' or 'Made in China' can drastically alter the duty rate,

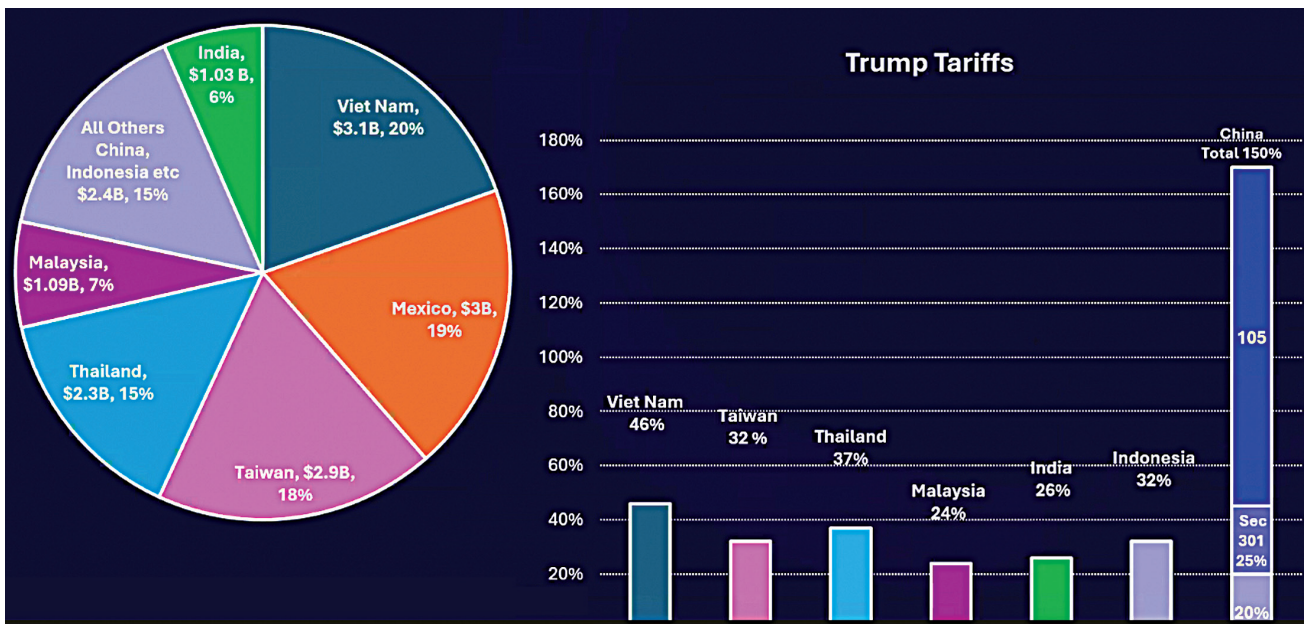


Fig. 5: Major exporters of switching and routing apparatus (851762) to the USA